DESIGN NOTES

Ask about the last time

Five interview questions that give you something to inspect

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Start with a recent event

01 Pick one customer task you need to understand.

02 Ask about the last time the person did it.

03 Let them explain the sequence before suggesting a solution.

Replace a request for opinions

01 Instead of: Would you use a tool for this?

02 Ask: Tell me about the last time you did this task.

03 Follow up: What started it, and what happened next?

DESIGN NOTES

Ask where the task became difficult

01 Instead of: Was the process frustrating?

02 Ask: Which step took more work than you expected?

03 Follow up: What did you do to get past that step?

Look for a real choice

01 Instead of: Is price important?

02 Ask: What options did you compare last time?

03 Follow up: What made you choose the one you used?

DESIGN NOTES

Understand the workaround

01 Instead of: Would this feature help?

02 Ask: How are you handling this part today?

03 Follow up: Can you show me an example, with private details removed?

Separate the record from the interpretation

01 Record the event and the words you heard.

02 Write your interpretation in a different note.

03 Choose what another interview or a test needs to check.